

Microsoft Fabric
Naming Convention Guidelines

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1. Purpose

This document defines standardized naming conventions for all data assets within Microsoft Fabric. Consistent naming ensures clarity, discoverability, and long-term maintainability across the platform — from raw Bronze ingestion through Silver transformation to Gold consumption layers.

2. General Standards

- Use snake_case for all asset and column names (default)
- Use lowercase only
- Avoid spaces, hyphens, and special characters
- Keep names concise but descriptive
- Bronze layer columns may preserve source system casing for raw data fidelity
- All Silver, Gold, and other asset names must follow snake_case

3. Asset Naming Conventions

Use the patterns below. Tokens in {braces} are placeholders — replace with meaningful, abbreviated values (e.g., source = jde, qb, tcs).

Asset Type	Naming Pattern	Example
Lakehouse	lh_{source}_{layer}	lh_jde_silver
Warehouse	wh_{source}_{purpose}	wh_jde_log
Pipeline	pl_{destination_table}	pl_dim_accounts
Deployment Pipeline	dpl_{source}	dpl_jde
Semantic Model	{descriptive_purpose}	finance_model

4. Column Naming Standards

4.1 Default Format

- All Silver, Gold, and Warehouse column names must be snake_case
- Lowercase only — no mixed case unless config-driven (see §4.2)
- Prefer readability; apply standard abbreviations where established (see §4.4)

4.2 Exception — Config-Driven Columns (table_column_metadata)

The wh_etl_metadata warehouse contains the table_column_metadata table, which stores each JDE table name alongside a FRIENDLY_LABEL for every column. These friendly labels are in lower camel case (e.g., productGroup, dispatchGrp).

If a developer dynamically references these labels directly in a data pipeline or notebook — for example, reading FRIENDLY_LABEL at runtime to drive EL transformations — the original lower camel case casing may be preserved as-is. No manual renaming is required in that case.

If the column name is hardcoded or defined manually at any point downstream, the preference is to convert to lower snake_case.

Dynamic use (acceptable): productGroup read at runtime from
table_column_metadata.FRIENDLY_LABEL → may remain productGroup

Hardcoded / manual (convert): productGroup defined manually → rename to
product_group

All derived or calculated columns must always follow snake_case regardless of source.

4.3 Numeric Handling

4.3.1 Leading Numbers — Spell Out

If a column name would start with a digit, spell the number out as a word:

2nd Item Number → second_item_number

3rd Party Vendor → third_party_vendor

4.3.2 Trailing Single Digits — Use Leading Zero

If a column name ends with a single-digit number, pad it with a leading zero:

Order Type 1 → order_type_01

Region 9 → region_09

4.4 Approved Abbreviations

Use the following standard abbreviations. Do not introduce new abbreviations without team review.

Abbreviation	Full Phrase
mph	Miles per hour
uom	Unit of measure
qty	Quantity
num	Number

Abbreviation	Full Phrase
id	Identifier
dt	Date
amt	Amount
desc	Description

4.5 Column Naming Examples

Original Name	Column Name	Rule Applied
2nd Item Number	second_item_number	Leading number → spell out
Order Type 1	order_type_01	Trailing digit → leading zero
Order Number	order_number	Standard snake_case
Miles Per Hour	mph	Use approved abbreviation
Unit Of Measure	uom	Use approved abbreviation

5. Layer-Specific Rules

5.1 Bronze Layer

- Column names may preserve source system casing (raw fidelity)
- Asset names (Lakehouse, Pipeline) still follow snake_case
- Example Lakehouse name: lh_jde_bronze

5.2 Silver Layer

- All column names must be converted to snake_case
- Apply numeric handling rules (§4.3) and abbreviations (§4.4)
- Example Lakehouse name: lh_jde_silver

5.3 Gold Layer

- All column names must be snake_case and business-friendly
- Dimension and fact tables: descriptive names (e.g., dim_branch_plant, fact_sales_order)
- Example Lakehouse name: lh_jde_gold

6. Governance & Contacts

Naming consistency is critical for downstream BI, semantic models, and automated pipelines. Deviations must be reviewed and approved before implementation.

6.1 Review Process

- Document proposed deviations with a business justification
- Submit via the IT Data & Analytics team channel or ServiceNow request
- Approved exceptions are recorded in the team naming convention log

6.2 Contacts

When in doubt, reach out to Andrew or Shweta for confirmation before implementing a new naming pattern.

Appendix — Quick Reference

Category	Rule / Pattern
Default format	snake_case, lowercase, no spaces
Bronze columns	Source casing may be preserved
Silver+ columns	snake_case required
Leading digit	Spell out: 2nd_ → second_
Trailing single digit	Pad with zero: _1 → _01
Lakehouse	lh_{source}_{layer}
Warehouse	wh_{source}_{purpose}
Pipeline	pl_{destination_table}
Deployment Pipeline	dpl_{source}
Semantic Model	{descriptive_purpose}
Questions / deviations	Contact Andrew or Shweta